

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

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 **Partly sunny 72/52 • Tomorrow: Mostly sunny 76/57 B16** *Democracy Dies in Darkness* **SATURDAY, MAY 30, 2026 • \$4**

Kennedy venue told to scrub new name

Judge says addition of ‘Trump’ must go, orders halt to 2-year closure

BY JONATHAN EDWARDS

A federal judge Friday ordered that President Donald Trump’s name be scrubbed from the John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts and that officials halt plans to close the venue for two years, dealing a significant legal blow to the administration’s sweeping renovation project.

U.S. District Judge Christopher Cooper granted in part Rep. Joyce Beatty’s (D-Ohio) request for a preliminary injunction temporarily blocking steps toward closure. He also ordered Kennedy Center officials to remove Trump’s name from the center’s building and branding within two weeks.

“Congress gave the Kennedy Center its name,” Cooper wrote in his opinion, “and only Congress can change it.”

The twin rulings throw the center’s near future into uncertainty. Leaders had laid off staff in anticipation of a closure, and the decision could now leave the institution open with an empty performance calendar.

The decision is the most significant point in two lawsuits filed against Kennedy Center leadership over the Trump administration’s involvement in affairs big and small at the performing arts institution.

In December, Beatty, an ex officio member of the Kennedy Center’s board, sued her fellow trustees days after they voted to rename the institution “The Donald J. Trump and The John F. Kennedy Memorial Center for the Performing Arts.” Beatty said she was muted during the virtual board meeting when she tried to voice opposition to the name change, a

SEE CENTER ON A2

A cooler head, but no prevailing



GUGLIELMO MANGIAPANE/REUTERS

Serbia’s Novak Djokovic uses ice packs Friday on Day 6 of the French Open in Paris, where temperatures again topped 90 degrees. His quest for a record 25th Grand Slam was ended by Brazil’s Joao Fonseca after a five-set fight in the third round. **Story, B7**

Trump says he’s nearing approval on deal with Iran

HE SUMMONS AIDES TO SITUATION ROOM

Main terms are nuclear program, strait reopening

BY NATALIE ALLISON AND SUSANNAH GEORGE

President Donald Trump signaled Friday that he is moving closer to approving a deal to extend a ceasefire in Iran, announcing a Situation Room meeting to “make a final determination.”

Trump said in a social media post that some unspecified aspects of a deal “have been agreed to,” while also outlining what he described as his most important conditions. It was unclear whether Iran had agreed to them all,

including the stipulation that the United States would unearth and destroy Iran’s highly enriched uranium.

Trump also said Iran must immediately reopen the Strait of Hormuz, remove any remaining mines in the vital waterway and “agree that they will never have a Nuclear Weapon or Bomb.”

He said that “no money will be exchanged, until further notice,” possibly a reference to calls by Iran for the U.S. to release the country’s frozen assets.

A White House official said Friday afternoon that the Situation Room meeting had concluded but did not provide further details.

Senior officials from the U.S. and Iran said earlier this week that they had reached a tentative agreement to suspend the months-long war in the Middle

SEE IRAN ON A4

Kenya court blocks U.S. plan for Ebola hospital

BY RAEI OMBUOR, LENA H. SUN AND ADAM TAYLOR

NAIROBI — A Kenyan court Friday suspended a Trump administration plan to establish a makeshift field hospital in Kenya to quarantine and treat Americans exposed to or infected with Ebola.

The court, citing a threat to life, issued its ruling on the day U.S. officials said the facility would begin operating. It has capacity for up to 50 patients potentially exposed during the growing Ebola outbreak, which is centered in the Democratic Republic of Congo.

Authorities say suspected Ebola cases have passed 1,000, with nearly 250 suspected deaths.

The court ruling, which is temporary pending fuller consideration of the case June 2, nonetheless halted a key part of the strategy from President Donald Trump’s administration for handling Americans exposed to Ebola overseas.

The decision leaves uncertain how the U.S. government would manage Americans exposed to the virus if they need evacuation in the coming days, as there is no ready backup plan, according to a person familiar with the U.S. response.

The court ruling also puts added focus on ethical questions related to the administration’s apparent unwillingness to let ill or exposed Americans return home

SEE EBOLA ON A8

Ruling freezes \$1.8 billion payout fund, for now, as litigation continues

BY SALVADOR RIZZO

A federal judge in Virginia has temporarily blocked the Trump administration’s plans for a nearly \$1.8 billion fund to pay people who claim they were unfairly investigated or prosecuted, ruling that no money can go out the door for now.

U.S. District Judge Leonie M. Brinkema said in a brief order docketed Friday that officials with President Donald Trump’s administration are temporarily barred “from taking any further action pursuant to the creation or operation of the Anti-Weaponization Fund, which includes

the transferring of money to the Fund; the consideration of any claims submitted to the Fund; and the disbursing of any funds from the Fund.”

The judge scheduled a hearing for June 12 in U.S. District Court in Alexandria, Virginia, on whether the fund should remain blocked while the court weighs a legal challenge from several plaintiffs represented by the group Democracy Forward.

In an unusual move, Trump recently agreed to drop a \$10 billion lawsuit he had filed against the IRS over the 2019 leak of his confidential tax records, and in exchange his administra-

tion agreed to establish the \$1.776 billion fund to pay applicants who show they were improperly targeted by the government.

The fund has provoked criticism from ethics watchdogs who question how it was created, and say it would be used to benefit Trump’s allies and supporters.

Plans for the fund have generated rare bipartisan pushback in Congress and at least four federal lawsuits. Hundreds of people who were convicted of rioting offenses on Jan. 6, 2021, or their lawyers have said they will be requesting payments.

SEE FUND ON A4



BRENDAN HOFFMAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Vladyslav Tovstyi, right, a Ukrainian drone battalion commander, stands in a command post in May.

Ukraine’s drones are tipping the scales

After a brutal winter and four years of war, Kyiv looks to have stronger hand

BY STEVE HENDRIX AND SERHII KOROLCHUK

DONETSK OBLAST, UKRAINE — As a fifth summer fighting season begins in Russia’s full-scale war against Ukraine, Vladyslav Tovstyi directs dozens of operators flying thousands of drones from an

underground command center that looks more like a tech startup than a forward bunker.

High-definition monitors lined the insulated walls, each showing a drone’s-eye view of a doomed Russian soldier in a foxhole, an enemy supply truck, countryside striped with trenches and razor

wire. On one, a ground robot was delivering food and ammo to a forward unit — a Ukrainian soldier gave a thumbs-up to the camera as he unloaded a box.

From his ergonomic Secretlab gaming chair, Tovstyi monitored his team’s efforts along the front

SEE UKRAINE ON A11

IN THE NEWS

Attacks on Jewish sites Fears are heightened ahead of this weekend’s Israel Day Parade in New York amid rising antisemitic violence. **A3**

High-potency treatment Patients lose “spectacular” amounts of weight on Eli Lilly’s GLP-1 medicine. But doctors say with greater potency comes greater risk. **A9**

THE NATION **The massive Blue Origin rocket** explosion gives Elon Musk an edge in space race. **A6** **Little evidence** for claims that China and propaganda drive data center opposition. **A13**

THE WORLD **A Russian drone** hit an apartment building in Romania and exploded, authorities said, injuring two people and threatening to inflame tensions between Moscow and NATO. **A10**

THE ECONOMY **Southwest Airlines**, which drew flak from the plus-size community for tightening its extra-seat policy, has now loosened restrictions. **A16** **Wall Street** pushed further into the record books amid its winning streak and closed out a solid month of gains. **A16**

STYLE **An exhibition** at the Smithsonian Castle, “American Aspirations,” is in pursuit of a true picture of the nation. **B1**

SPORTS **Elijah Sarratt** rose from a zero-star recruit with one scholarship offer to a fourth-round pick with the Ravens. **B7**

THE REGION **Five people** were killed and dozens were injured in a crash on I-95 in Stafford County, Virginia, involving a bus and six vehicles. **B12** **Series finale:** We’ve taken you inside seven of Washington’s most exclusive and historic diplomatic buildings. **B12**

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